

Unit 1

a) Define Oral communication. Explain the need and significance.

Oral communication is the process of verbally transmitting information and ideas from one individual or group to another. Oral communication can be either formal or informal. Examples of informal oral communication include:

- Face-to-face conversations
- Telephone conversations
- Discussions that take place at business meetings

The goal of learning a language is to communicate. Oral communication skills are fundamental to the development of literacy and essential for thinking and learning. It is the glue that puts all the components of a language together. Some of the benefits are:

(i) Building Friendships

Socially, good oral communication skills enable you to effectively share information, thoughts, feelings, needs and intentions. You can create close relationships and bond with family, friends and people at work. A good listener is almost always appreciated.

(ii) Knowledge Acquisition

The learning process often requires you to have an inquiring mind. Good oral communication skills will help you acquire knowledge more effectively, especially when you are able to ask questions, express opinions and ideas, and summarize information.

(iii) Developing workplace competencies:

Business and professional people depend a lot on oral communication skills when they engage in different activities. Educationists deliver lectures and hold tutorials, discussions, forums and seminars.

b) How will you draft a speech ? What are the factors you need to be considered ?

Giving an original speech for a class, event, or work presentation can be nerve-wracking. However, writing an effective speech can help to bolster your confidence.

1. Research your topic well.

If you are writing an informative or persuasive speech, then it should be very well researched! This will help to give you credibility and make your points far more convincing. Seek out scholarly sources, such as books, academic journals, newspaper articles, and government websites to find information and support for your claims.

2. Make an outline that includes your main argument and points.

Organising your ideas and research into an outline is a great way to check for completeness and flow before you actually draft the speech. In general, a speech should include an introduction, 5 main points with supporting evidence (such as statistics, quotes, examples, and anecdotes), and a conclusion. Use a numbered structure or simply outline your speech using bullet points.

3. Address each of your main points in a logical order.

After introducing your topic and providing context, launch right into your points. State each point clearly and offer additional information, evidence, facts, and statistics to explain each of your points. Plan to devote about 1 paragraph to each of your points.

4. Introduce new topics and summarise material you have already covered.

Another way to help your audience understand the points you are making is to provide a brief 1 to 2 sentence overview before you move onto a new topic and then summarise the material in 1 to 2 sentences after you finish explaining it. Put the previews and summaries in plain, simple terms to help make your points clear to your audience.

5. Include transitions to guide your audience through your speech.

Transitions improve the flow of your speech and help readers see how your points are connected. Check to make sure that you have included transitions throughout your speech. Some common transition words and phrases include: Then, Next, Before, After, First, Second, In that moment, The following week

6. Conclude your speech with a call-to-action.

As you near the end of your speech, your audience should be excited by your topic and ready to act. Encourage your audience to find out more and participate in a solution to the problem you have described by telling them how they can do so. This is a great opportunity to share resources with your audience and to give them some direction for how they can participate.

Unit 2

c) What is debate? Explain the kinds of debate.

Debate is a process that involves formal discussion on a particular topic. In a debate, opposing arguments are put forward to argue for opposing viewpoints. Debate occurs in public meetings, academic institutions, and legislative assemblies. It is a formal type of discussion, often with a moderator and an audience, in addition to the debate participants.

There are different types of debates. We can classify the debate into many kinds. Here are some kinds of debate:

1. Lincoln- Douglas debate: It is a kind of debate where there is only one speaker in the side of affirmative as well as in the side of negative. Usually affirmative side of speaker begins the debate and followed by the negative sided speaker. This kind of debate is also known as “Two men debate”.
2. Rebuttal debate: It is a kind of debate where each team from affirmative and negative side having two to three members in the team forms a debate. It is only difference that the debate is between not two people but it is between two teams. Even here the affirmative sided starts debate and negative sided team will follow the debate.
3. One Rebuttal debate: It is a modified form of Rebuttal debate where the two teams will form the debate. In this debate all of the speakers have the chance of refute argument except one person who had been given chance to speak in the previous turning from the affirmative side. And that person will be given chance to windup the debate discussion at the end of the session.
4. Oregon- oxford debate: It is the traditional debate format used in the governor’s debate, house debate rules, parliamentary debates, colleges and all over the country. There are two sides in this debate affirmative and negative side. The debate starts with the negative sided speaker and it will be followed by the affirmative speaker. Here the team members will be decided with the particular defenders in another team and they are not supposed to defend their answers with other members of the team.

d) What are the elements to be considered for a good story?

There are 6 key elements to be considered for a good story. They are as follows:

1. Setting:

This element of the narrative is incredibly important. Setting establishes the time, place, and environment in which the main characters or narrator operates. Crafting a high-quality setting is the difference between a believable story and one that falls flat.

2. Characters:

Once the time place and location is set it is must that one should decide what the characters to be involved in the story are. There are mainly 3 types of characters which are very essential for a good story:

- a) Central characters: A character is any person, animal, or figure represented in a literary work. Characters are essential to a good story.
- b) Protagonists: A protagonist is the central character or leading figure in poetry, narrative, novel or any other story. A protagonist is sometimes a “hero” to the audience or readers.
- c) Antagonists: The antagonist is the opposing force that brings conflict and is instrumental in the development of the protagonist, or main character. Every good story should have an antagonist.

3. Plot:

Plot is a literary term used to describe the events that make up a story, or the main part of a story. These events relate to each other in a pattern or a sequence. The structure of a novel depends on the organisation of events in the plot of the story. A plot is a causal sequence of events, the “why” for the things that happen in the story. The plot draws the reader into the character’s lives and helps the reader understand the choices that the characters make.

4. Conflict:

In works of narrative, conflict is the challenge main characters need to solve to achieve their goals. Traditionally, conflict is a major literary element that creates challenges in a story by adding uncertainty to if the goal would be achieved. A narrative is not limited to a single conflict. Conflict, such as a power struggle between a hero (or protagonist) and villain (or antagonist) is arguably the most important element in fiction because without conflict there is no movement and no narrative drive. Totally it is an obstacle created by antagonist towards other characters or protagonists.

5. Theme:

In literature, theme refers to the main idea or moral of the story. Sometimes this main idea or moral is stated directly, and sometimes the reader has to think about the main idea. In most literary works, there could be more than one theme. The theme in a story is its underlying message, or ‘big idea.’

The theme may be of two types called as major theme where there will be only one single idea around which story revolves. But Minor theme means that the theme or idea which is often shown in the story.

6. Narrative Arc:

It is a way in which a story would be told to the audience. It is a talent of narrative a story in the form of arc where all the above mentioned elements to be included.

- a) Higher tension: It is the point where the conflicts are narrated in such a way that the tensions are higher than one another or the suspense and thrill twist moment of the story.
- b) Climax: The point of pooling all the scenes and characters together is called as climax. It is the place where most of the tensions are created and the decision regarding the problems is taken and also all the suspense are made known to the audience.
- c) Resolution: It is the end of the whole journey of the story. Here the protagonist will understand the situation and also the oral of the story will be revealed to the audience.

Unit 3

e) Explain the types of interview based on the task and count of people involved.

1. Based on the task:

1. Apprenticeship interview:

Here the interview is very formal one with general questions and some skill related questions being asked.

2. Evaluation interview:

In this interview, a fixed set of questions are asked and a scoring system evaluates the points scored. This type of interview negates the scope of personal bias of the interviewer.

3. Promotion interview:

This is for an employee of the company seeking a higher position for career enhancement purpose.

4. Counselling interview:

When employees are called and their problems and solutions are discussed within the organisation, such meeting type interviews are called counselling interviews.

5. Disciplinary interview:

Here an individual or number of employees or sometimes the employee union is interviewed for their misconduct or non-performance. This is more sort of a meeting between the manager and the employees to get the problem resolved.

6. Persuasive interview:

The interviewee here has to persuade the interviewer to accept his point of view as in case of an employee persuading his manager to implement some changes in the policy or a sales manager persisting on selling a product.

2. On the basis of count of people involved:

1. One-to-one interview (Personal interview):

It is the most common among the interview types, it involves the interviewer asking questions maybe both technical and general to the interviewee to investigate how fit the candidate is for the job.

2. Group interview:

This involves multiple candidates and they are given a topic for discussion. They are assessed on their conversational ability and how satisfactorily they are able to have their own views and make others believe in them. Here, the best among the lot gets selected.

3. Panel interview (Committee Interview):

The interviewers here are a group from among the company people who are in senior position and usually the panel interview is when the candidate is supposed to make a presentation.

f) How do you manage while facing interview.

1. Research the industry and company.

An interviewer may ask how you perceive his company's position in its industry, who the firm's competitors are, what its competitive advantages are, and how it should best go forward. For this reason, avoid trying to thoroughly research a dozen different industries. Focus your job search on just a few industries instead.

2. Clarify your "selling points" and the reasons you want the job.

Prepare to go into every interview with three to five key selling points in mind, such as what makes you the best candidate for the position. Have an example of each selling point prepared. And be prepared to tell the interviewer why you want that job – including what interests you about it, what rewards it offers that you find valuable, and what abilities it requires that you possess.

3. Anticipate the interviewer's concerns and reservations.

There are always more candidates for positions than there are openings. So interviewers look for ways to screen people out. Put yourself in their shoes and ask yourself why they might not want to hire you ("I don't have this," "I'm not that," etc.). Then prepare your defence: "I know you

may be thinking that I might not be the best fit for this position because [their reservation]. But you should know that [reason the interviewer shouldn't be overly concerned].”

4. Prepare for common interview questions.

Every “how to interview” book has a list of a hundred or more “common interview questions.” Pick any list and think about which questions you’re most likely to encounter, given your age and status (about to graduate, looking for a summer internship). Then prepare your answers so you won’t have to fumble for them during the actual interview.

5. Line up your questions for the interviewer.

Come to the interview with some intelligent questions for the interviewer that demonstrate your knowledge of the company as well as your serious intent. Interviewers always ask if you have any questions, and no matter what, you should have one or two ready. If you say, “No, not really,” he or she may conclude that you’re not all that interested in the job or the company.

6. Practice, practice, practice.

It’s one thing to come prepared with a mental answer to a question like, “Why should we hire you?” It’s another challenge entirely to say it out loud in a confident and convincing way. The first time you try it, you’ll sound garbled and confused, no matter how clear your thoughts are in your own mind! Do it another 10 times, and you’ll sound a lot smoother and more articulate.

7. Score a success in the first five minutes.

Some studies indicate that interviewers make up their minds about candidates in the first five minutes of the interview – and then spend the rest of the interview looking for things to confirm that decision! Come in with energy and enthusiasm, and express your appreciation for the interviewer’s time. Also, start off with a positive comment about the company.

8. Be assertive and take responsibility for the interview.

Perhaps out of the effort to be polite, some usually assertive candidates become overly passive during job interviews. But politeness doesn’t equal passivity. An interview is like any other conversation – it’s a dance in which you and a partner move together, both responding to the other. Don’t make the mistake of just sitting there waiting for the interviewer to ask you about that Nobel Prize you won. It’s your responsibility to make sure he walks away knowing your key selling points.

9. Be ready to handle illegal and inappropriate questions.

Interview questions about your race, age, gender, religion, marital status, and sexual orientation are inappropriate and in many areas illegal. Nevertheless, you may get one or more of them. If you do, you have a couple of options. You can simply answer with a question (“I’m not sure how that’s relevant to my application”)

10. Make your selling points clear
11. Think positive.
12. Close on a positive note.
13. Bring a copy of your resume to every interview.
14. Don’t worry about sounding “canned”.
15. Make the most of the “Tell me about yourself” question.
16. Speak the right body language.
17. Be ready for “behavior-based” interviews”.
18. Send thank-you notes.
19. Don’t give up!

g) Write a note on types of interview based on the judging abilities.

Based on judging the abilities:

1. Behavioural-Based interview:

The interviewee is asked questions about the past work experiences and how it was dealt with in a particular situation. This helps the interviewer understand the candidate’s future performance based on his past experiences. Here the candidates need to provide examples when they have handled situations. The probing maybe in detail to assess the candidate’s behaviour and responses and this determines the candidate’s future job prospects.

2. Problem-solving interview (Task Oriented interview):

Here the interviewer is more concerned about the problem-solving abilities be it technical, managerial, creative or analytical skills. This is the most common among the interview patterns and it may involve either writing and answering a questionnaire set or answering the technical questions orally.

3. Depth interview (In-depth interview):

When you need to ascertain everything about the interviewee right from the life history, academic qualifications, work experiences, hobbies, and interests; you conduct the depth

interview. Here the interviewer has a clear idea about the questions he will be asking but once the question is asked, he allows the conversation to flow and is more of a listener. This interview takes time and more of a friendly approach of the interviewer towards the interviewee.

4. Stress interview:

Very rare, but such interviews are conducted to see how the candidate will be able to react in stressful situations and to assess if he will be able to handle the crisis at his job.

The tactics involved include:

Completely ignore the candidate by maybe, making a phone call in the middle of the interview. Or some other tactic like continuously interrupting the candidate when he answers the questions. Trying to enforce your point of view forcefully even if he disagrees. Asking a whole lot of questions all at once. Interrupting him by asking another question not related to his answer.

Unit 4

h) **How do you follow telephone etiquette? Mention any 6 telephone etiquettes.**

Telephone Etiquette Proper telephone etiquette an important facet of communication. Remembering to use proper telephone etiquette, whether answering or making calls, leaves your respondents with a favourable impression of you.

Answering Calls:

- Try to answer the phone within three rings.
- Answering a phone too fast can catch the caller off guard and waiting too long can make the caller angry.
- Answer with a friendly greeting.

Making Calls

- Always know and state the purpose of the communication.
- If you told a person you would call at a certain time, call them as you promised. If you need to delay the conversation, call to postpone it, but do not make the other person wait around for your call.
- If you don't leave a number/message for someone to call you back, don't become angry if they are not available when you call again.

Handling Rude or Impatient Callers

- Stay calm. Try to remain diplomatic and polite. Getting angry will only make them angrier.
- Always show willingness to resolve the problem or conflict.
- Try to think like the caller. Remember, their problems and concerns are important.

Transferring Calls

- If the caller needs to speak to another person or department, transfer the caller directly to the desired person's extension rather than the operator. This will save the caller having to explain his/her requests another time, and it will cut the number of times the caller needs to be transferred.
- When transferring a caller, tell them who you are transferring them to, and announce the caller to the person you are transferring them to.
- If the called party does not wish to take the call, return to the caller (Example – “He/she is out of the office, may I take a message or would you like his/her voicemail?”)

Taking Messages

- Be prepared with pen and message slip when you answer the phone.
- When taking messages be sure to ask for:

Caller's name (asking the caller for correct spelling.)

Caller's phone number and/or extension (including area code)

- If the caller is a student, ask for the Student ID# (if appropriate) and ask about the subject of the call.
- Repeat the message to the caller.

Ending Conversations

- Leave the conversation open, and let the other party end the conversation.
- Promise to finish your discussion at another time.
- Tell the person how much you've enjoyed speaking with him/her.
- Before hanging up, be sure that you have answered all the caller's questions

i) Mention some of the video conferencing etiquettes

1.Video — meet first.

If it's important, make your first meeting by live video. They will feel more comfortable with you, be more likely to forgive your imperfections, and give you the benefit of the doubt. You will seem more sincere. This is your opportunity to make a good first impression.

2. Prepare yourself.

Look clean and well groomed, but don't overdo it as that will appear insincere. Don't distract them with flashy jewellery, dramatic make-up or wild styles. Business casual and low key wins the day. Have a drink of water before you go on. Put a smile on your face and sit up straight.

4. Clean your desk.

Don't have anything between you and the camera that says you're messy or disorganised. Lose the stack of papers, sticky notes and potato chips. Consider the visual message you are sending.

5. Aim your camera.

Check your camera angle. Ideally, it should be coming from the middle of the screen or even with their eyes. Don't sit too close or your head will appear much too large. Look at the camera when you speak. Don't put the camera to your side.

6. Prepare your background.

If you have a sunny window directly behind you, close the blind. Think about what they see behind your head. A clean wall or curtain is better than a cluttered office or weird artwork. Remember, you don't want to distract them, so look to see what they see before you call.

7. Prepare your presentation

Have in mind exactly what you want to convey, what commitments you want from them, and be prepared for questions. Books, pictures or shared documents are great props to use.

8. Small talk first.

Talk about the weather or something neutral to give them time to adjust to you and how you speak. They are taking in a lot of information at first so make it friendly. Don't talk too fast.

9. Give and take

Be sure to give them ample opportunity to respond and ask questions. Ideally, they should talk as long as you do. Take notes. Listen closely to their remarks and address them before you go on with your points.

10. Smile and say goodbye.

Look at the camera. Give a friendly wave goodbye and thank them for the meeting.

11. Send a follow-up.

Right after your live video meeting, send them a thank you email saying how much you enjoyed meeting with them and politely summarise the action items.

Unit 5

j) Explain the objectives and significance of Public Relations.

Public relations is a strategic communication process companies, individuals, and organisations use to build mutually beneficial relationships with the public.

The main objective of public relations is to maintain a positive reputation of the brand and maintain a strategic relationship with the public, prospective customers, partners, investors, employees and other stakeholders which leads to a positive image of the brand and makes it seem honest, successful, important, and relevant.

1. Creating awareness about the company, its goals, products and services where this counts.
2. Sustaining the awareness

Sustaining the awareness as an ongoing process, keeping in mind what the competitors are doing, and knowing that public memory is short.

3. Striving to be accepted by the various publics.

Special efforts are required to be accepted by employees. A foreign company has its own requirements for being accepted on this soil.

4. Creating a bond of trust.

In times of rumours, misinformation, etc., a company has to establish the truth. In normal times, too, a company has to promote its reliability. Just consider the frequent use of words like believe, trust, reliable, safe, 100%, etc. In building a company image.

5. Getting cooperation from various quarters.

A company has many publics on whom it has to depend. Government organisations, providers of various services etc. Have to be wooed in such a way that they willingly help the company.

6. Earning recognition.

It is not enough to perform feats but it is necessary to get these noticed and talked about. Through winning awards, certifications etc. And getting these read and seen, a company gets recognition. Having so-and-so as a client or collaborator may itself be a recognition. This has to be publicised.

k) Explain the role of Media in PR.

Media planning is truly a specialist job today. From hoardings at busy suburban railway stations like CST or Church gate, daily seen by lakhs of commuters, to internet – deep inside the computer tube, there are too many media today. But audio-visual media maintain their primacy.

The tools of public relations are:

1. TV:

Here your skill in PR is seen in the programmes your sponsor and in the decorum of your presentations. The TV announcer's voice is often more effective to drive home your slogan than the paid artist or the celebrity

2. Print media – newspapers and magazines:

While ads do their work, good PR lies in contributing useful scholarly articles to appropriate magazines and newspapers. An article on motivation or on economy by a company's chairman would do much to enhance its image.

3. Films:

Films about a company's working and its unusual activity (e.g. oil exploration, disease control) can be used for fostering public relations. These films can be shown at customers' meets, exhibitions, press meets, in-house get-togethers, etc.

4. Literature:

Brochures, information booklets, leaflets etc. Are specially devised literature for image-building. They can be coupled with calendars, lists of holidays, useful telephone numbers, etc.

5. Direct mail:

Some banks send birthday greetings to their customers. Similarly, season's greetings, sympathy cards, invitations etc. Can be used as a bridge to reach a company's established as well as new clients.-

6. Internet:

Internet is an ever-expanding medium with unexplored possibilities. It is also a very effective tool for reaching special interest groups who would be visiting certain sites or using certain features of internet (like email).

7. Radio:

The Radio, an audio device, has certain advantages over the TV. It can play in the background without involving the eye. Its importance needs to be properly rated, since it is a highly under rated medium in today's India. Agricultural products can be popularised by effective use of the radio.

8. Oral communication and stage manners:

This is not the least device of public relations. Customers see employees' dresses and manners with some attention. Consider a savings account clerk in a bank. Customers have to stand and wait in front of him/her. They get ample time to watch the functionaries. All personnel who have to deal with the public need to be trained groomed and counselled from the PR angle.

